

Growing up

Many young insects, such as flies and beetles, look very different from full-grown adults. Like caterpillars, they also start life as crawling larvae and turn into flying adults inside a hard case called a pupa.



Young fly larvae
(or maggots)



Adult
blue bottle fly



Young
ladybug larvae



Adult
ladybugs

4

Changing shape

The chrysalis changes color as the caterpillar changes into a butterfly.



5

Splitting open

Finally, the chrysalis breaks open and the adult butterfly crawls out. Its large, crumpled wings have to expand and dry before it can fly.



Some butterflies fly 2,000 miles (3,200 km) to lay eggs.



6 Flying away

The butterfly flies away to visit flowers and feed on their sweet nectar. After mating, female butterflies lay their eggs on plants and the life cycle starts again!